

2026 AUSTRALIAN JUNIOR CHESS CHAMPIONSHIP PROBLEM SOLVING U12 CANBERRA

NAME: _____

DATE OF BIRTH: _____

Please circle your age group:

- U8 (2 Jan 2018 or after)
- U10 (2 Jan 2016 or after)
- U12 (2 Jan 2014 or after)

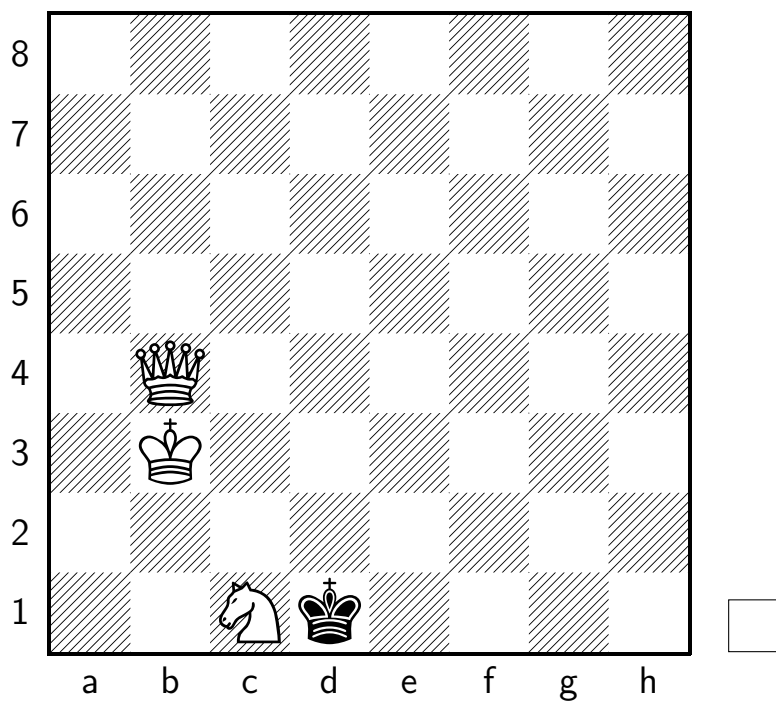
Please circle: Boy or Girl

Please read the following rules.

- You have up to 2 hours for the problem solving paper. You may not need all that time. You may leave after handing in your answers.
- The questions generally go from easy to hard, so it's best to start from the beginning and go in order.
- You can use your chess board and pieces to help you.
- Each page show a question and the marks you can score. Please write your answers in the space under each diagram. Altogether, the test has 100 marks. Even if you don't give perfect answers, you can still get some partial marks.
- For endgame puzzles, show enough moves to reach a position where you are clearly winning or drawing.
- You don't have to finish them all, do your best and solve as many puzzles as you can.

Enjoy the problem solving.

Q1. Mate in 2. (4 marks)



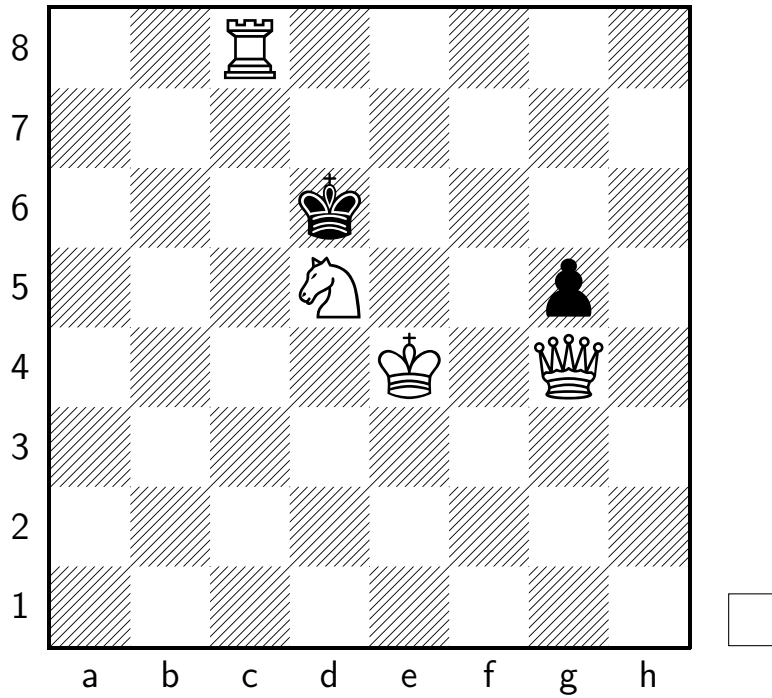
Answer:

1 ♔a5 ♚xc1

2 ♔e1#

Source: 9 Authors Deutsche Schachzeitung, 1968 (YACPDB: 82713)

Q2. Mate in 2. (4 marks)



Answer:

1 ♔f5 ♔d7

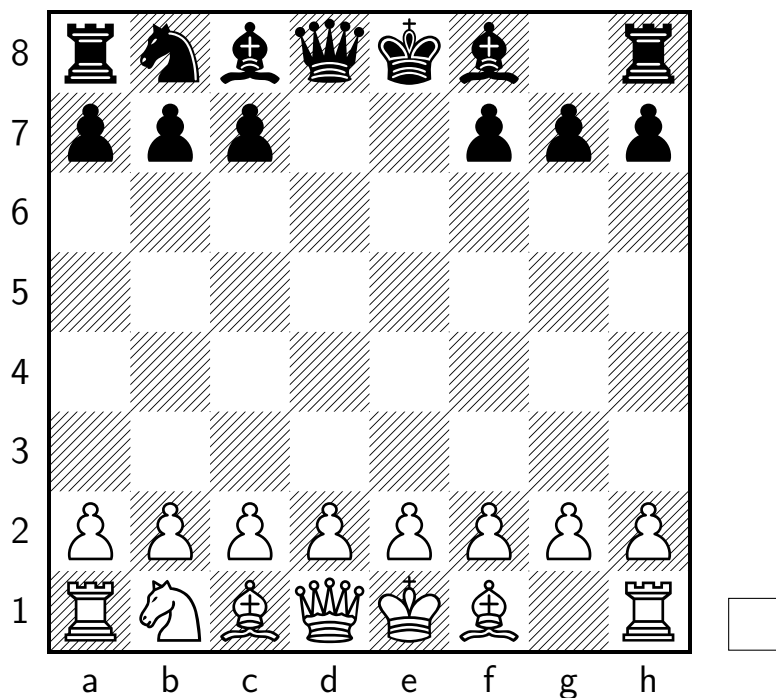
2 ♔e7#

1... ♔xd5

2 ♕d1#

Source: Samuel Loyd, Buffalo Commercial Advertiser, 1879 (YACPDB: 32755)

Q3. The position below occurred at the 4th Black's move from the starting position. List the moves that resulted in this position. (4 marks)

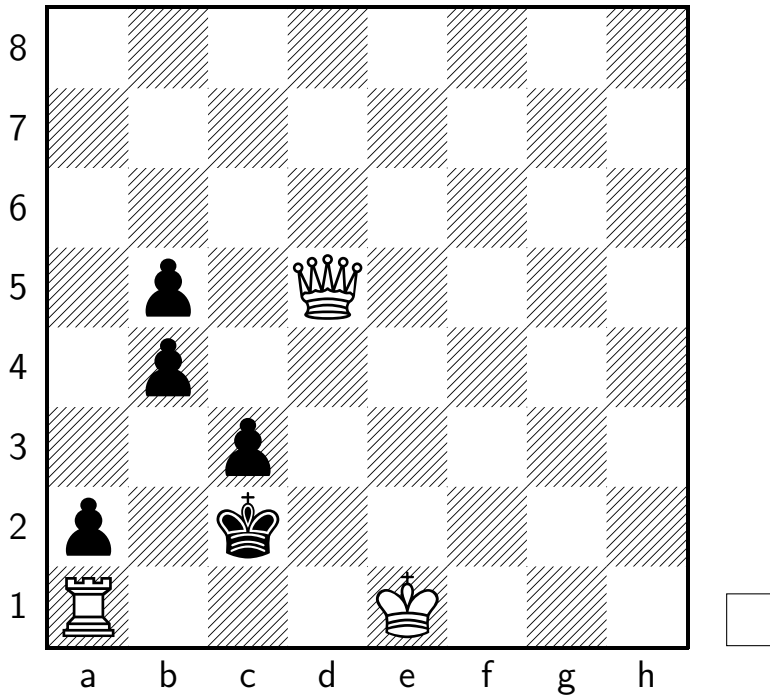


Answer:

- 1 ♖f3 e5
- 2 ♖xe5 ♖e7
- 3 ♖xd7 ♖ec6
- 4 ♖xb8 ♖xb8

Source: Ernest Clement Mortimer (version by Andrey Frolkin) Die Schwalbe, 1981

Q4. Mate in 2. (4 marks)

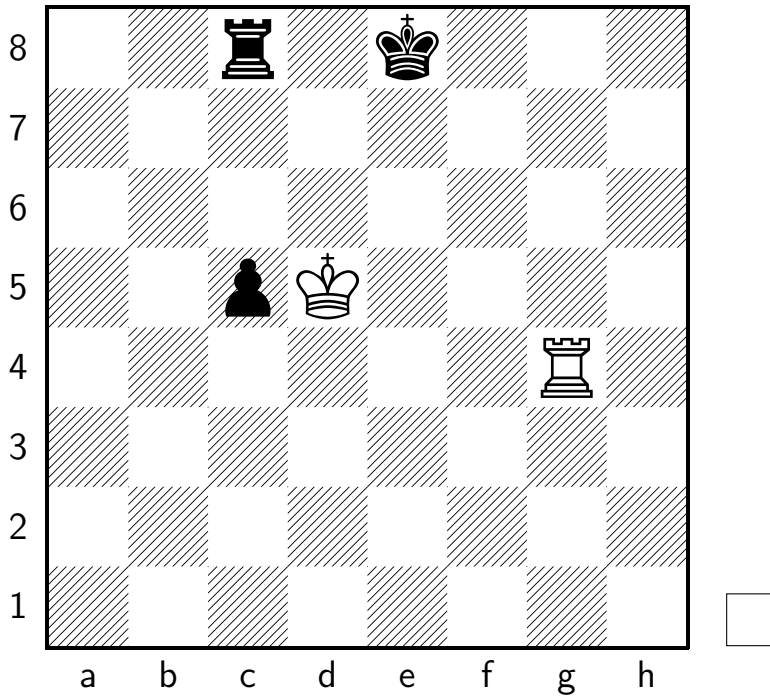


Answer:

1 ♔e6! ♕d3
2 O-O-O#

Source: William Whyatt, Chess World, 1957 (YACPDB: 28136)

Q5. White to play and win. (6 marks)

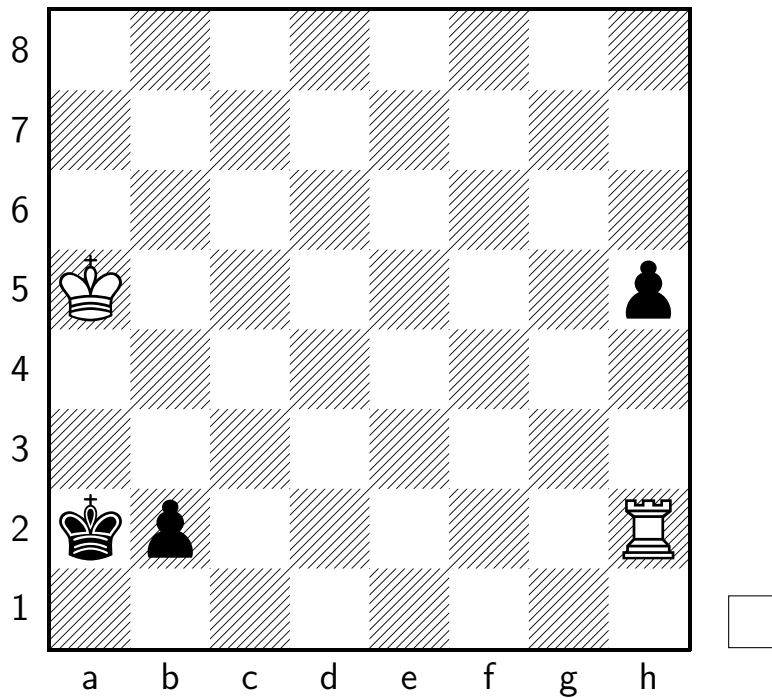


Answer:

- 1 ♖g8+ ♔d7
- 2 ♖g7+ ♔e8
- 3 ♖h7! c4
- 4 ♔d6! ♖d8+
- 5 ♔e6 ♔f8
- 6 ♔h8+ ♔g7
- 7 ♖xd8

Source: Alexey Studenetsky, Shakhmaty v SSSR, 1939

Q6. White to play and draw. (6 marks)



Answer:

1 ♔a6! (Counterintuitive. The move makes a space for the rook.)

1... h4

2 ♔a5 h3

3 ♔a4 ♔a1

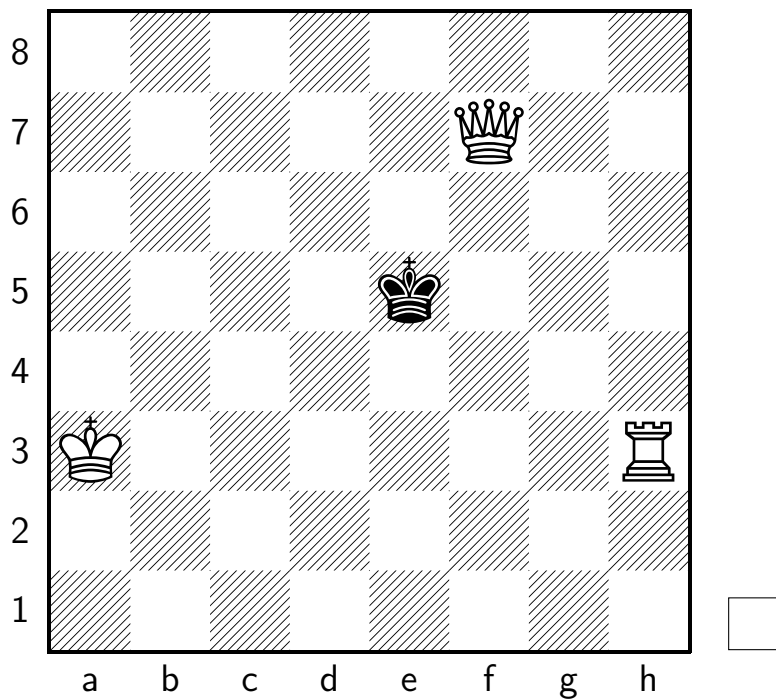
4 ♖xh3 b1♔

5 ♖a3+ ♔a2

6 ♖xa2+ ♔xa2

Source: David Gurgendze, Tiny Endgames, 1999 (YACPDB: 276417)

Q7. Mate in 3. (6 marks)



Answer:

1 ♔b4 ♕d6

2 ♖h5 ♔c6

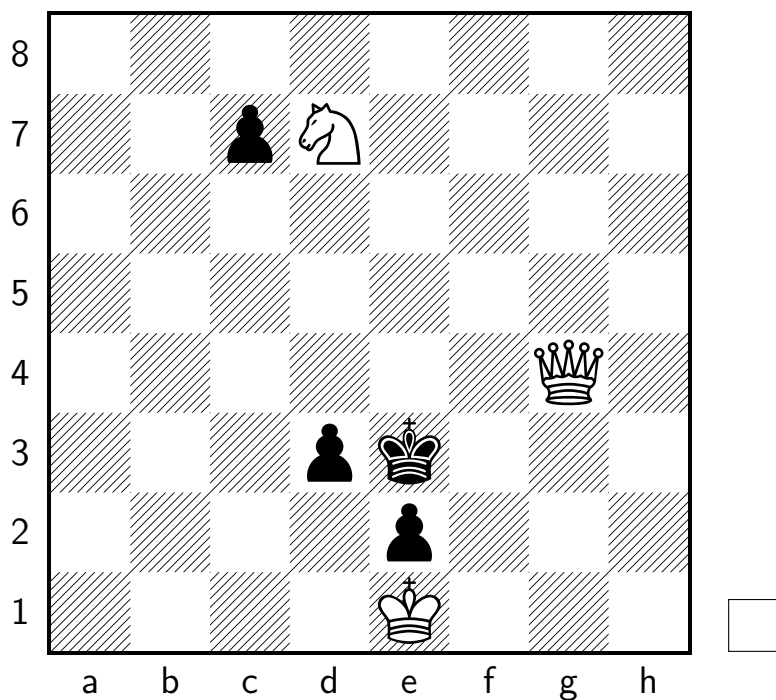
3 ♖h6#

If 1... ♔d4, 2 ♕e8 ♔d5 3 ♖d3#.

If 1... ♔e4, 2 ♔c5 ♔e5 3 ♖e3#.

Source: Frederick Baird, 1905 (YACPDB: 105882)

Q8. Selfmate in 2. White forces Black to mate the White King with Black's 2nd move. (6 marks)

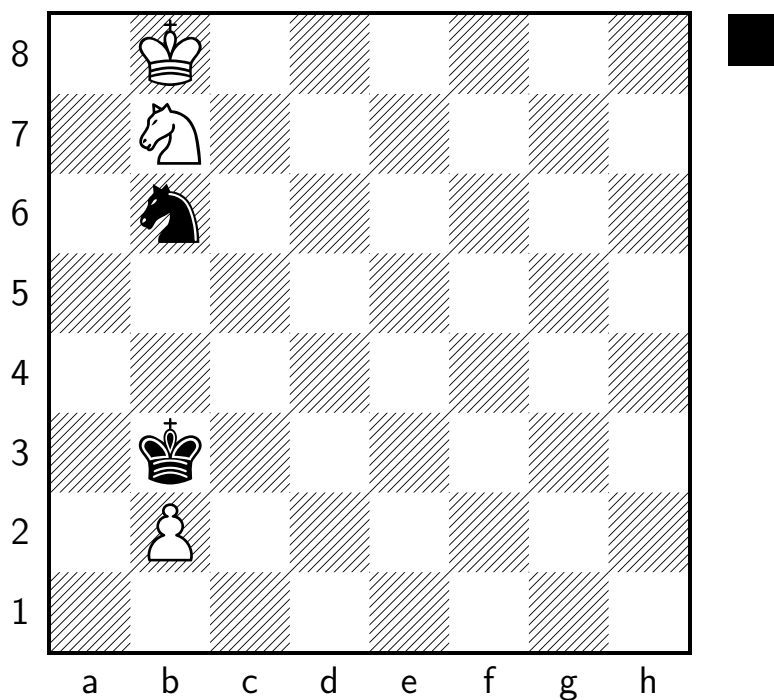


Answer:

1 ♞e5 c5
2 ♚c4 d2#

Source: Alexander Hildebrand, Springaren, 1998 (YACPD: 90375)

Q9. Helpmate in 3. Black to moves first and helps White checkmate in 3 moves. (6 marks)



Answer:

0... ♖d5

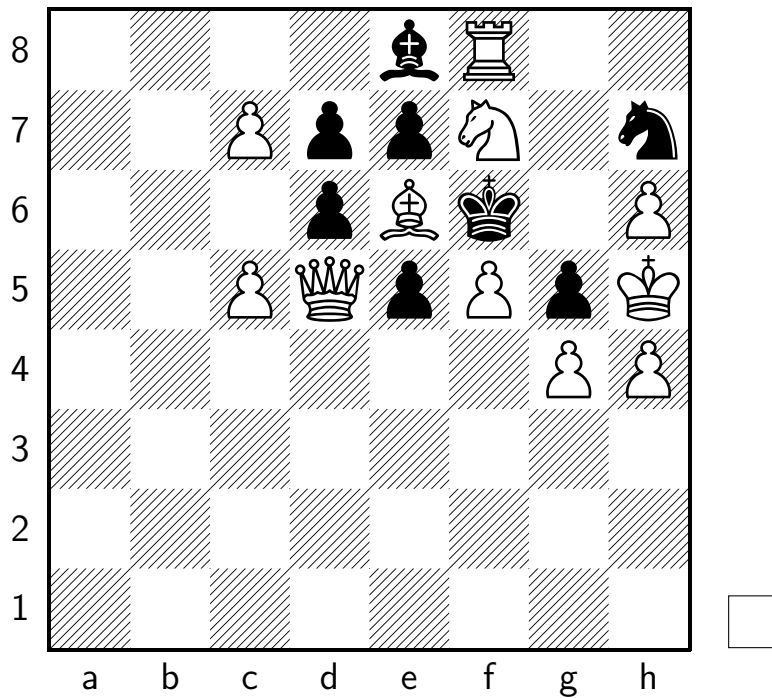
1 ♔a7 ♘b4

2 ♔b6 ♔a4

3 ♘c5#

Source: Henrik Eriksson, stella polaris, 1967 (YACPDB: 303520)

Q10. Mate in 2. (8 marks)



Answer:

The previous Black move has to be a pawn moving, g2-g4, to checkmate the Black king in two moves.

1 f×g6! (en passant)

1... ♖g5 2 h×g5#

1... ♖×f8 2 g5#

1... ♙×f7 2 ♖×f7#

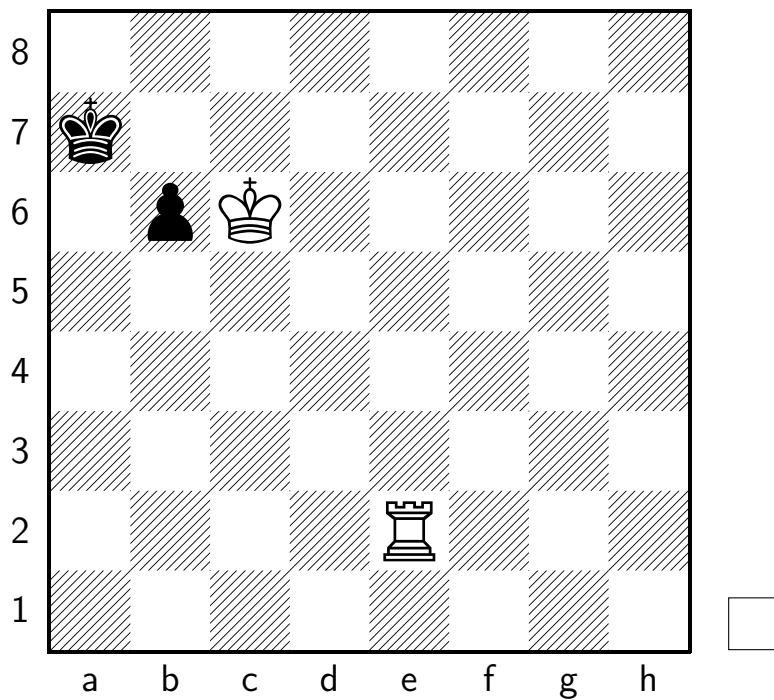
1... d×c5 2 ♔×e5#

1... d×e6 2 ♔f3#

1... e4 2 ♔f5#

Source: Hristofor Savvich Animica, Mat (Beograd), 1974 (YACPDB: 233762)

Q11. Mate in 3. (8 marks)



Answer:

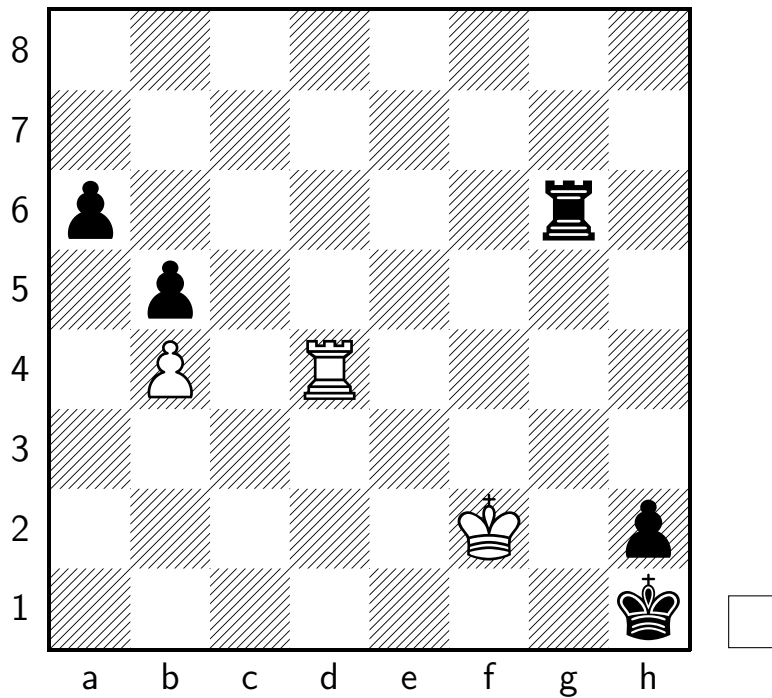
1 ♖c2

1... b5 2 ♕c7 b4 3 ♜a2#

1... ♖a8 2 ♕c7 b5 3 ♜a2#

1... ♖b8 2 ♕xb6 ♖a8 3 ♜c8#

Q12. White to play and win. (8 marks)

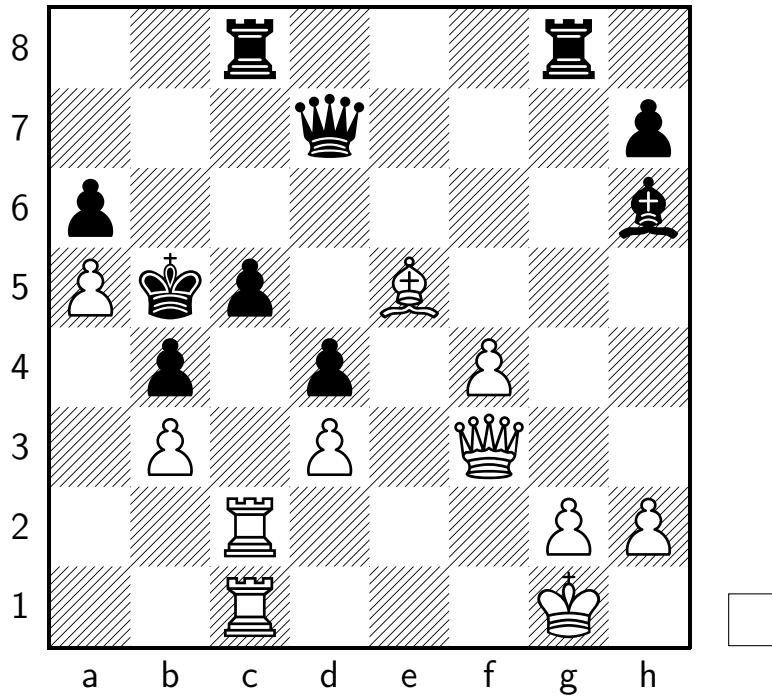


Answer:

1 ♖d1+ ♜g1
 2 ♜f1! ♜xf1+
 3 ♔xf1 a5
 4 bxa5 b4
 5 a6 b3
 6 a7 b2
 7 a8♚#

Source: Philippe Stamma, Essai sur le Jeu des Echecs, 1737 (modified)
(YACPDB: 394020)

Q13. White to play and win. (8 marks)



Answer:

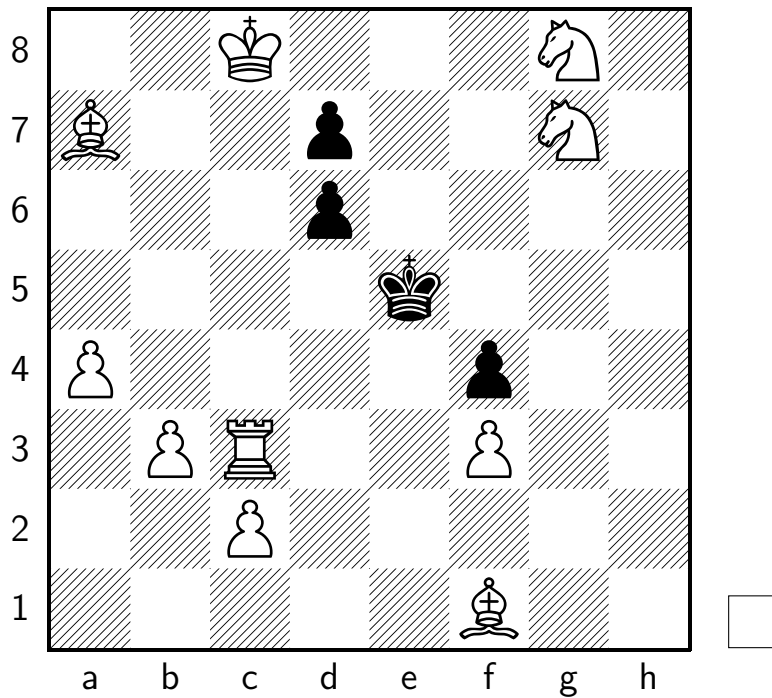
1 ♖c7!

If 1... ♜xc7, 2 ♛b7+! ♜xb7 3 ♜xc5#.

If 1... ♛xc7, 2 ♜xc5+ ♛xc5 3 ♛xb7+ ♛b6 4 ♛xb6#.

Source: Tarrasch - Marotti 1914

Q14. Mate in 3. (8 marks)



Answer:

1 ♖g2! ♔d5

2 ♜e3 fxe3

3 f4#

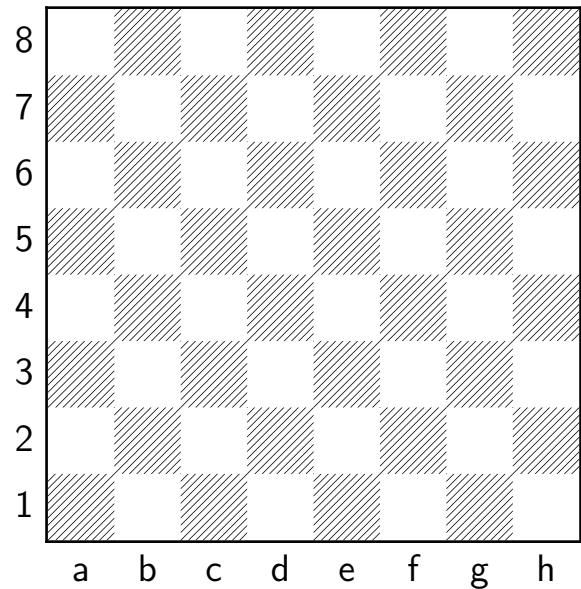
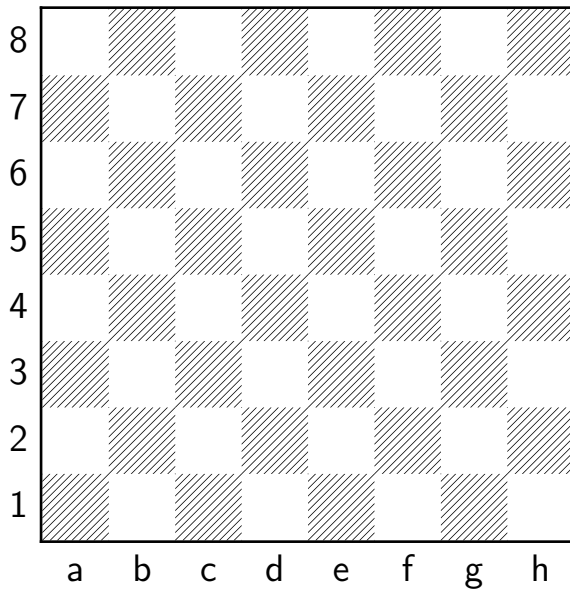
1... d5 2 ♔xd7 d4 3 ♜c5#

1 ♔d7 d5 2 ♜d3+ ♔e5 3 ♔c6 d5 4 ♜d5# (takes 4 moves)

Source: Thomas Denton Clarke, The Brisbane Courier 1918

Q15. 5 Queens Domination puzzle. Place 5 queens on the board so that all the squares are attacked by those 5 queens. (6 marks)

Do you know? There are 7,624,512 ($_{64}C_5$) patterns to place 5 queens on the board. Among those pattern, 4,860 patterns are correct. In one episode of "Take Take Take" YouTube channel, Magnus Carlsen took about 5 minutes to complete this task. Can you beat him?

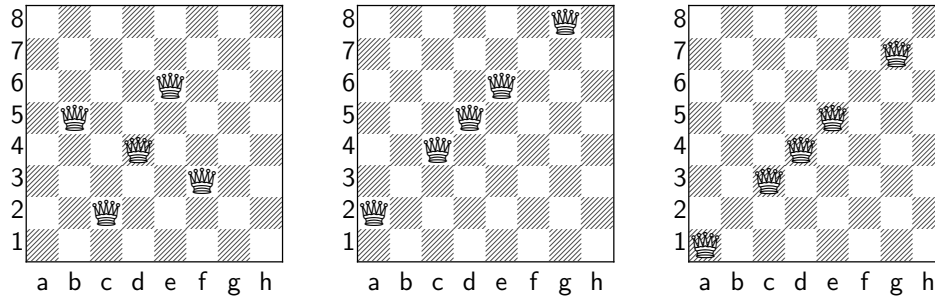


Instruction:

Use your 5 pawns instead of queens. Fill 5 squares in the left board with the letters "Q". When you make mistakes in the left board, put a large cross on the left board and use the right board.

Answer:

Some of representative solutions are shown below.



The left solution shows the central queen surrounded by the other four queens in knight positions.

Five queens lie on a main diagonal in the middle solution and on a sub-diagonal in the right solution.

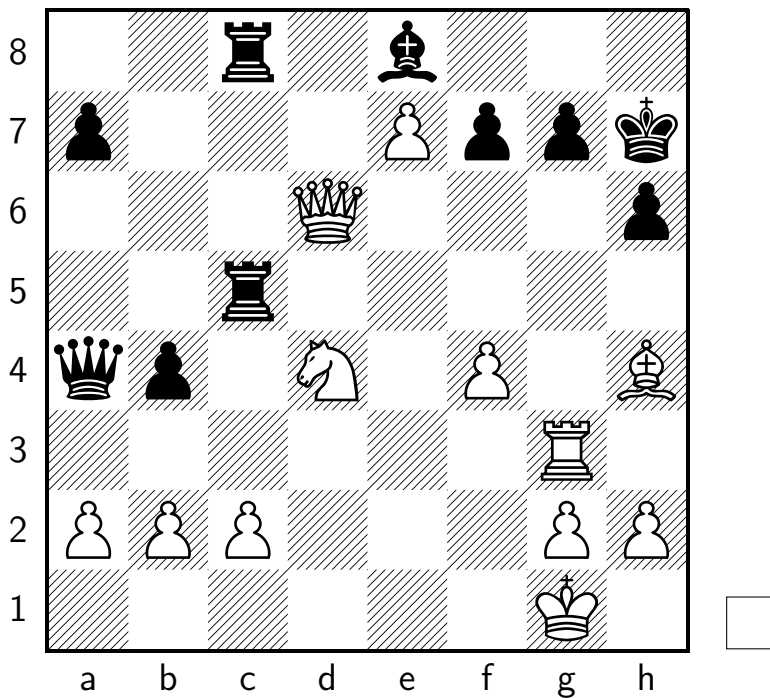
References:

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Queen%27s_graph

<https://www.brainbashers.com/queens.asp>

Q16. Mate in 8. (8 marks)

In memory of Daniel Naroditsky (1995-2025). He is an American grand master and a famous streamer as "Danya". He tragically passed away in October 2025 at the age of 29.



Answer:

1 ♖xg7+!! ♔xg7
 2 ♕f6+ ♔g8
 3 ♘e6!! fxe6
 4 ♕f8+ ♔h7
 5 ♙f6 ♖g5
 6 f×g5 ♔g6
 7 g4 ♕xc2
 8 ♕g7#

2... ♔h7 3 ♘f5 ♖xf5 4 ♕xf5+ ♔h8 5 ♙f6+ ♔g8 6 ♕g4+ ♔h7 7 ♕g7#

Source: Daniel Naroditsky - Timur Gareyev, U.S. Championship Online Qualifier, 2020